

Module Title: *Dissertation in Development Education and Global Learning*

Name of Candidate: Stéphane Jacquet

Full title of award for which candidate is registered: *MA Development Education and Global Learning*

Title of assignment: Perceptions of Global Citizenship Among International Students at De Montfort University, Leicester

Name of Marker: Douglas Bourn and Nicole Blum

Feedback comments from marker:

Overall comments

This is a very good, thoughtful, clear and well-written dissertation. Its focus on global citizenship among international students at De Montfort is well-structured, well-argued, analyses the evidence appropriately and comes to some original and important conclusions.

If a criticism could be made it is that the theme that students do not appear to have a critical approach could have been explored more. The evidence to substantiate this theme whilst evident is perhaps not quite as clear-cut as being suggested.

The research questions are appropriate if rather ambitious.

Your role as a researcher and also academic tutor to some of the students is an important point and some reference to some of the literature around this area might have helped.

With regard to specific chapters, the Introductory chapter is particularly good and argues very well the rationale and context for the study.

The Literature review rightly adopts some specific themes rather than trying to cover everything concerning global citizenship and internationalisation. The strongest sections are the discussions on global citizenship and cosmopolitanism. I felt the section on identities was less strong but this is probably because this in itself is such a big area. Perhaps more could have been made in terms of the implications for the themes on identities in terms of debates on global citizenship but this is a contested area anyway and could well have taken you down a number of areas that go beyond the scope of the dissertation.

The diagrams are good and perhaps more could have been made of them.

The methodology chapter outlines the approach taken clearly. The limitations of the study are well put.

The findings chapter is also good but I found some of the evidence here not as strong as perhaps the conclusions are suggesting. It might also have helped if reference could have been made to comparing the findings to other similar research on students' perceptions of global citizenship.

The Concluding chapter with the recommendations is good although perhaps here there is too much of an emphasis on a series of bullet points.

Grasp of Field of Study (awareness of issues and insights into the field of study, understanding and critical review of literature, and application of knowledge)

The discussion includes a compelling personal rationale for the choice of topic, but could have said more about how the study contributes to/ builds on existing literature on these issues. For instance, how much has been written about international students' perspectives on global citizenship elsewhere? This is literature that you should have made some reference to, even if it is very limited.

Noting its limitations could in fact be part of the argument for the originality of your own work.

The discussion of the literature around global citizenship and education for global citizenship is well done, and shows critical engagement with these ideas. At some points, however, it is not quite clear how you have arrived at specific conclusions. The frameworks for global citizenship (figure 1) and learning for GC (figure 2), for instance, clearly draw on the discussion of literature, but don't clearly set out how/ why you arrived at the choice of these as key elements for your own understanding.

You also provide some nice reflections on yourself as researcher and teacher, and the implications of this for your study.

Methodological and Research Skills (understanding and evaluating research and methodologies, appropriateness of chosen methodology and research design, analysis and discussion of data)

The dissertation shows a good overall understanding of the research process. This includes useful discussion of your research questions, the methods you used and relevant ethical concerns. Further discussion of exactly how you went about doing your analysis would also have been helpful. Although you talk about ethical issues throughout the methodology chapter, the actual discussion under that heading is very short. It might have been more clear to try to set these all out in one place.

The research questions are too broad for a study of this size and could have been more focused. By being quite ambitious in what you want to look at, you end up without much space for in-depth discussion. You could reasonably have simply used the first question as the basis for a whole study, for instance, perhaps alongside some more detailed sub-questions (e.g. linked to topics such as cosmopolitanism, English language learning, etc. which you later identify as important).

In addition to your interview data, it would also have been useful to draw on university policies and curriculum documents, etc. in order to support your discussion. For instance, in section 4.2.5 you say: *The implementation of global perspectives in the curricula is not evident and internationalisation seems reduced to the mere recruitment of overseas students, without adequate structures for genuine inclusion or global learning. Intercultural competence seems relegated to incidental learning.* While this may be an accurate statement it's hard to see what evidence this is based upon, so could be read as simply your opinion (rather than a conclusion based on research).

As a general rule, full transcripts of all interviews should not be included in a dissertation or published work. There is no requirement to share your data publically, and it could actually cause problems for the confidentiality of your participants. Any data that you want to share with your reader should be integrated into the discussion. As a maximum, you can include the interview questions and a sample transcript in the appendices.

Structure, Communication and Presentation (focus, organisation, cogency, clarity, fluency, accuracy)

The dissertation is confidently written and nicely structured, so the discussion has a nice flow overall.

It was a joy to read in terms of its clarity, being well-organised with good signposting from section to section.

Although it's OK to organise the discussion around the research questions, you could have provided more detail about where the sub-questions came from. Did these emerge from your analysis? This would be helpful for your reader to know.

Provisional grade*: A

**It should be noted that this is a recommended grade which will be presented to the board of examiners. Confirmed, final grades will only be provided subsequent to the meeting of the Examination Board.*